

## ASIA'S 50 BEST RESTAURANTS 2026

**GAGGAN,** Bangkok No 3 and Best Restaurant In Thailand
**MASQUE,** Mumbai- No 15 and Winner Of The Art Of Hospitality Award And The Best Restaurant In India
**NAAR,** Himachal - No 30

### EXTENDED LIST 51- 100

**PAPA'S,** Mumbai – No 66
**THE TABLE,** Mumbai – No 73
**INJA,** New Delhi – No 75
**FARMLORE,** Bengaluru- Following One To Watch In 2025; Now at No 83 On The List





Headlining destination dining, ensconced in its quiet Himalayan abode, 'Naar' (No.30) has made significant noise conquering new frontiers. Helmed by Chef Prateek Sadhu, its smoky, rugged cuisine whispers the smells, sounds, and soul of the mountains. It's not about chasing trends any more, India is creating its own legacy. And the world is beginning to notice.

### DECODING THE MATRIX

It's when chefs don't just cook but inspire others to rethink the very essence of food that signals a revolution. "Over and above the awards, what's always been the end goal for us is to run a successful, well-loved restaurant where all the seats are sold out every day", says Totlani, Head Chef Masque & Bar Paradox Mumbai.
At Dubai's Tresind Studio, Himanshu Saini (India's first 3 Michelin star chef) is most proud of the team they have built. "What stays is the culture in the kitchen, the discipline, the respect, and the shared belief in what we're trying to do, which I hope encourages others to value teamwork and shared values", he says.
Championing less noise, more depth, Naar is moving towards preserving ingredients, not just serving them. "Seed saving, fermentation archives, documenting Himalayan foodways before they disappear. The restaurant is just one expression", chips in Sadhu, Chef Patron, Naar.

### WHERE TASTE IS THE TEST

When Michelin star Chef Vivek Singh opened The Cinnamon Club in London 25 years ago with a 100% plated-dishes-only principle, and no curries or poppadoms on the menu, he believed that people ate with their eyes first, therefore care in plating and presentation was important! "A 3 -4 course eating format meant dishes were smaller than just conventional curries, carefully considered combinations and just enough so one felt satiated at four courses. Fast forward to now, meals have evolved into 12-15-20-25 courses with portions so small, sometimes you still leave hungry after 15 courses! As a result, flavours often get muted in order to allow for progression of courses, while dishes remain merely suggestive of the dish it was meant to be.

While stoking passions and stirring up surprises is power for the course, more often than not, the evolution of options, sizes of plates and presentation paradigms now include smoke, dry ice, leaves, shapes, stands, and tubes; a lot of innovation outside the dish itself that doesn't necessarily impact flavours. Certain dishes just cook, eat, and taste better when prepared in larger quantities, they lose their soul when attempts are made to modernise them. While presentation and care are important, ultimately, taste rules!" says Vivek Singh Chef, Author & Chief Dreamer celebrating 25 years of London's Cinnamon Collection.

"In truly great restaurants, taste still leads everything. Sustainability, farm-to-table sourcing, and beautiful plating are evolutions of respect: for the ingredient, the farmer, and the guest. The risk begins when story and spectacle become the dish, instead of supporting it. A perfect plate should do three things in harmony: Flavour, memory, and meaning. If flavour is missing, the other two collapse. The best chefs today understand restraint. They use technique and presentation to elevate taste, not distract from it. A dish should never feel like a performance first and a meal second. In the end, guests don't return for foam, smoke, or theatrics. They return for how something tasted, and how it made them feel", says Chef Vikas Khanna of Bungalow New York.